Intro to Using Azure Blob Storage SOP

Cognizant

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1. Intro to Using Azure Blob Storage

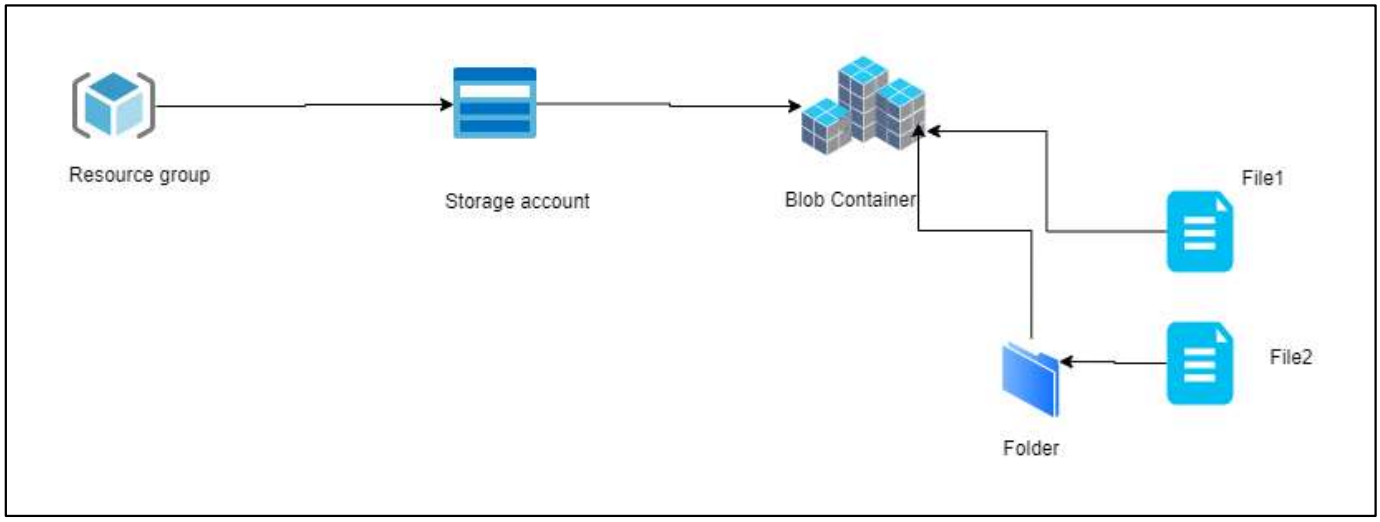
1.1 Description

Azure Blob storage is Microsoft's object storage solution for the cloud. Blob storage is optimized for storing massive amounts of unstructured data. Unstructured data is data that does not adhere to a data model or definition, such as text or binary data. Blob storage is designed for:

- Serving images or documents directly to a browser.
- Storing files for distributed access.
- Streaming video and audio.
- Writing to log files.
- Storing data for backup and restore, disaster recovery, and archiving.
- Storing data for analysis by an on-premises or Azure-hosted service.

1.2 Architecture Diagram

The diagram below displays a visual representation of the application architecture:



1.3 Lab Steps

Follow the steps outlined below to achieve the objective of this lab exercise:

1. Create a Storage Account:
    a. Click **All resources** in the Azure home page.
    b. Click **+ Add**.
    c. Click **Storage** > **Storage Account**.
    d. On the Create storage account page, configure the following settings:
        i. Resource group - Select the given resource group from the dropdown.
        ii. Storage account name - Give the account a unique name.
    e. Leave the other fields with their default values.
    f. Click **Review + create** > **Create**.
    g. Click the **notifications icon** at the top of the screen to monitor the progress of the deployment.
    h. When the deployment is complete, click **Go to resource**.

2. Create a Blob Container:
    a. Go to **Blob service** in the left pane.
    b. Click **Containers** under **blob service** header.
    c. Click **+ Container**.
    d. Name the new container **container1**.
    e. Click **OK**.

3. Upload Files to the Blob Container:
    a. Click **container1** to open our blob container.
    b. Click **Upload**.
    c. In the **Upload blob** menu, click the **folder icon**.
    d. Choose **storage.txt** (any file from your local) file to upload.
    e. Click **Upload**.
    f. In the **Upload blob** menu, click the **folder icon** again.
    g. Choose **storage1.txt** (any file from your local) file to upload.
    h. Click **Advanced**.
    i. In the drop-down list you get authentication type, blob type, blob size, access tier and upload to file.
    j. Under **Upload to folder**, type **json**.
    k. Click **Upload**.
    l. Close the **Upload blob** menu.

4. View Files in the Blob Container:
    a. In the **container1** menu, click the **storage.txt** file which was not uploaded to a folder.
    b. Click on the three dots to get the drop-down list.
    c. The list consists of view/edit, download, properties, edit metadata and etc.
    d. Click **View/edit** to view the file in its native format.
    e. Click **container1** at the top of the page.
    f. Click the **json** folder to open it.
    g. Click the **storage1.txt** file to open it.
    h. Click **View/edit** to view the file in its native format.

1.4 Troubleshooting

S. No	Problem	Solution
1	Issues loading Azure blobs	• Monitor the availability • Add different types of files in the folder to view in blob container

1.5 Supporting References

Refer the below links for additional information:

1. https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/storage/blobs/storage-quickstart-blobs-portal
2. https://docs.microsoft.com/en-us/azure/storage/blobs/storage-blob-create-account-block-blob?tabs=azure-portal